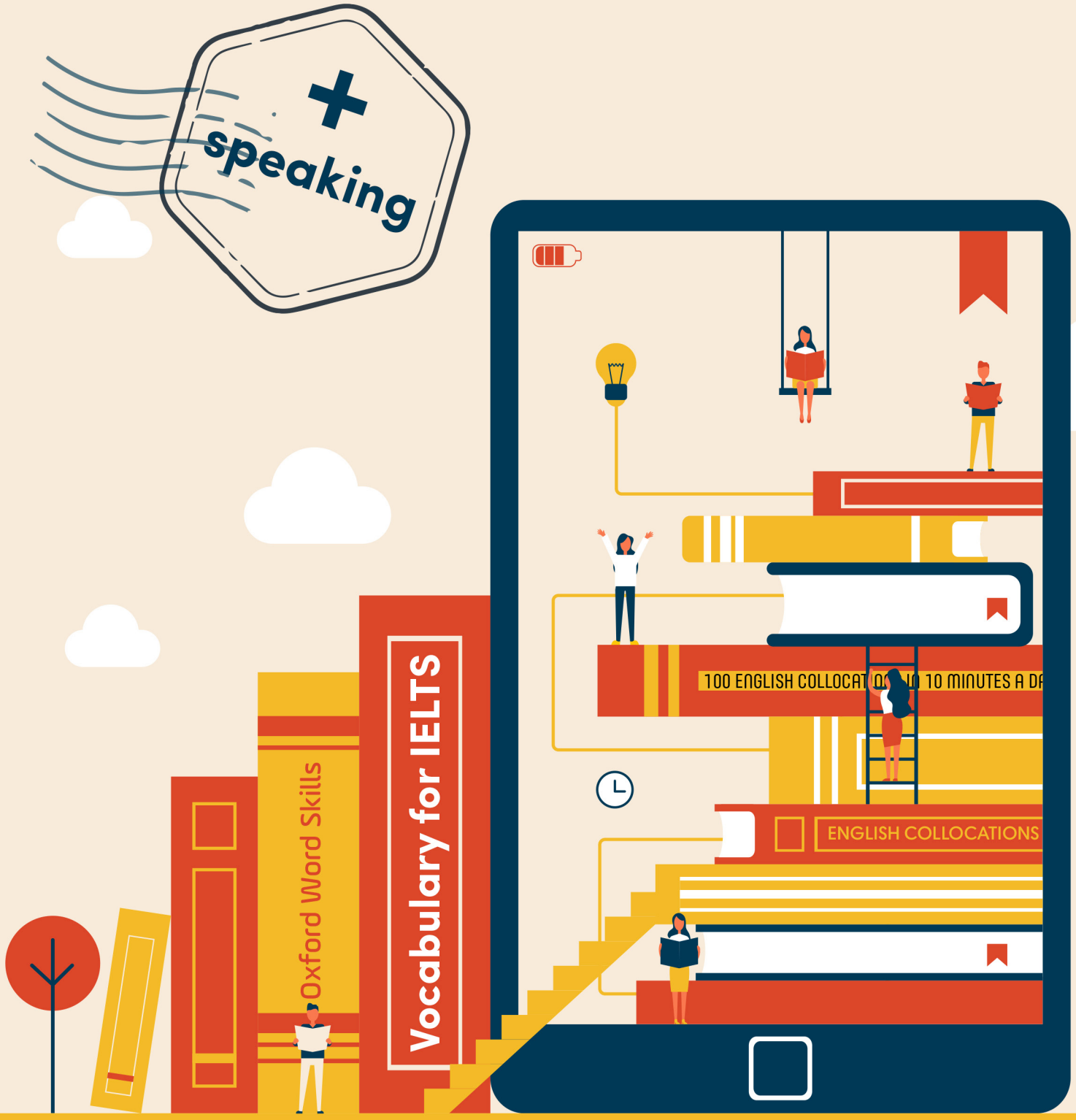
# IELTS Up Words!

# دوره لغات آیلتس

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# IELTS Up Words!

## Lesson 59: Plants

Hello there! How are you today? Are you having fun? Awesome! I hope you are doing well and ready for another one of our cool IELTS Up Words lessons. Haha.

In this lesson, we are not going to talk about mammals, amphibians, or even parasites. It is time to talk about vegetation! Yes, this topic is also popular in the speaking test of IELTS. Believe it or not, I was once asked this very question, that I am about to ask you, in one of the exams that I took.

Do you think you can answer it? Let's see! It is a part two question, so grab a pen and paper to take some notes first.

Describe a plant grown in your country.

What is the name of the plant?

What does it look like?

Where does it grow?

What are its uses?

I would like to talk about a special type of plant, from which saffron is derived. It is called saffron crocus and is thought to be a native plant of Iran. This plant has a bulb-like structure with a narrow and short stem. When it blooms, it turns into this stunning flower, which is purple or indigo in color. I am not quite sure about its fragrance, but I bet it smells like vanilla and spice.

I think Iran is the main cultivation area of saffron crocus today, especially in locations that receive enough annual rainfall. Since it is a fall-blooming plant, I believe it is best grown in colder climates, like that of the eastern provinces of Iran, and is usually planted in the summer and harvested by hand in the fall.

As I mentioned before, you can extract saffron from this plant, which is a widely popular spice used in Iranian cuisine. We use it to add flavor and vibrance to our food, such as rice and many stews. Even though saffron is synonymous with luxury in Iran, it does not stop homemakers to invest in a good amount of it. Saffron crocus is also used as an herb for medicinal purposes. For example, many use it to detoxify the body and cleanse the blood. I myself tried it once too, but I am not sure if it improved my health in any way.

To tell you the truth, I couldn't think of anything special on that test, so I decided to talk about cactuses! Yeah, I lied and described it as a native plant of Iran, since it is a sun-worshiping plant and can grow in the arid parts of Iran. And you know what? I got a nine on that exam for my speaking. As I have told you before, it doesn't matter if you make up a story or lie, what really matters is how well you can deliver your ideas.

# Speaking Tip



**Collective Nouns**

Collective nouns are names of a number or collection of people, animals, or things spoken about as one whole. Use them instead of words like “some” to add more precision to your descriptions and score higher.

| do not say some | translation | do not say some | translation |
|---|---|---|---|
| a pride of lions | دسته‌ای از شیرها | a crowd of people | جمعیتی از مردم |
| an army of ants; a colony of ants; a swarm of ants | ارتشی از مورچه‌ها؛ کلونی مورچه‌ها؛ گروهی از مورچه‌ها | a herd of sheep | گله‌ای از گوسفندها |
| a band of coyotes/ gorillas | دسته‌ای از کایوتی‌ها (گرگ‌های صحرایی) گوریل‌ها | a flock of geese | گله‌ای از غازها |
| a bask of crocodiles | گروهی از کروکودیل‌ها (که آفتاب می‌گیرند) | a paddling of ducks | دسته‌ای از اردک‌ها |
| a bed of snakes | گروهی از مارها | a school of fish | دستهٔ بزرگی از ماهی‌ها (که با هم حرکت می‌کنند) |
| a pack of wolves/ hounds | گله‌ای از گرگ‌ها/ سگ‌های شکاری | a swarm of bees | انبوه زنبورها |
| a cloud of bats | اجتماعی از خفّاش‌ها | a bunch of flowers | یک دسته گل |
| a clump of trees | انبوهی از درخت‌ها | a heap of wheat | یک خرمن گندم |

| topic-related words and structures | meaning | translation | other structures |
|---|---|---|---|
| **vegetation** | plants considered collectively | گیاهان | plant life; flora |
| **saffron is derived from this plant** | saffron is obtained from this plant | زعفران از این گیاه به‌دست می‌آید | acquire |
| **a native plant of Iran** | a plant that is indigenous to a given area (Iran) | یک گیاه بومی/محلی ایران | indigenous plants of Iran |
| **a bulb-like structure** | the structure resembles the shape of a bulb | ساختارپیازمانند | |
| **a short stem** | a stem is the main body of a plant which is above ground | یک ساقهٔ کوتاه | trunk; stalk |
| **this flower blooms** | When a flower blooms, it opens or is open | این گل شکوفه می‌کند/ می‌شکفد | blossom (verb) |
| **the main cultivation area** | the primary land area suited by climate and soil conditions to the growing of a certain type of crop or plant group | منطقهٔ اصلی کشت | growing region |
| **a fragrant flower** | a flower that has a pleasant or sweet smell | یک گل خوش‌بو | compare with odor and aroma; fragrance (noun) |

| topic-related words and structures | meaning | translation | other structures |
|---|---|---|---|
| **fall-blooming** | of plants that bloom during the fall (autumn) | گیاهانی که در پاییز شکوفا می‌شوند | autumn-blooming; autumn flowering |
| **to harvest** | to pick and collect crops, or to collect plants | برداشت‌کردن (محصول) | gather a crop |
| **to extract saffron** | to harvest saffron from the crocus flower | گرفتن زعفران از گیاه کروکوس | |
| **herb** | a type of plant whose leaves are used in making medicine or in cooking to give flavor to particular dishes | گیاه دارویی؛ سبزی | herbal |
| **a sun-worshiping plant** | a plant that is dependent on the sunlight to grow | گیاهی که به نور آفتاب برای رشد خود وابسته است | |
| **an arid environment** | an environment that has little or no rain, and is too dry to support vegetation | محیطی خشک و بی‌باران | a dried-up/ waterless environment<br>as dry as a bone |

| other words/ structures | meaning | translation | other structures |
|---|---|---|---|
| **mammals** | any animal of which the female feeds her young on milk from her own body | پستانداران | warm-blooded; vertebrate |
| **amphibians** | a type of animal that lives both on land and in water | دوزیستان | related: aquatic animals; terrestrial animals |
| **parasites** | an animal or plant that lives on or in another animal or plant of a different type and feeds from it | انگل‌ها | compared with pests<br>A parasite is an organism that lives in another organism, called the host, and causes the host some sort of harm. The word pest, however, is just a general term that means an unwanted creature. |
| **this very question** | the word very is used as an adjective to put emphasis | دقیقاً همین سؤال (تأکید) | |
| **indigo** | a deep reddish blue | آبی نیلی | |
| **annual rainfall** | the average amount of total rain that a place receives in a year | بارش سالانه | annual precipitation |
| **Iranian cuisine** | the Iranian style of cooking | آشپزی ایرانی | Iranian dishes |
| **stew** | a type of food consisting usually of meat or fish and vegetables cooked slowly in a small amount of liquid | خورشت | a hearty stew |
| **saffron is synonymous with luxury** | saffron is closely associated with luxury | زعفران ارتباط نزدیکی با چیزهای لوکس و تجملی دارد | |
| **homemaker** | a person, especially a woman, who manages a home | خانه‌دار | |
| **to detoxify the body** | to remove harmful chemicals from the body | سم‌زدایی کردن بدن | detox |
| **to cleanse the blood** | to make the blood clean or pure | تصفیه کردن خون؛ تمیزکردن خون | cleanse the cut/wound |



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